

Richard Milhous Nixon rose from humble Quaker origins in southern California to become Eisenhower's vice president and then president himself in the 1968 election. Although he brought American troops home from Vietnam, he went down in history for having to leave office in disgrace.

Born in 1913, Nixon grew up in the small community of Yorba Linda, on the outskirts of Los Angeles. In 1922, the family farm failed and the Nixons moved to nearby Whittier. When the health of his father also began to decline, Nixon turned down a scholarship to Harvard in favor of a college near home. He went on to earn a law degree from Duke University.